

1. *The Conscious Mind* by Chalmers (1996)

1.1. Introduction

1.1.1. Taking Consciousness Seriously

About consciousness as an “illusion”:

Page xii (Chalmers, 1996)

I have little idea what this could even mean. It seems to me that we are surer of the existence of conscious experience than we are of anything else in the world.

Doesn't an illusion require that there are things that are real, and things that just appear to be real, i.e., those illusions.

Chalmers starts with three constraints

- a. Take consciousness seriously
- b. Take science seriously
- c. Accept consciousness as natural phenomenon

Chalmers considers two problems or perhaps kinds of problems: The easy problems of consciousness that build upon the assumption that it can be understood by analysing cognition and behaviours. The hard problem is that those problems are insufficient for understanding the consciousness.

References

Chalmers, David J., *The Conscious Mind: In Search of a Fundamental Theory*, Oxford University Press, New York (1996).